

RULE BOOK

THE TENNIS CARD GAME · 2–4 PLAYERS · FIRST TO 7

WELCOME TO SLICE!

SLICE! is tennis in a deck of cards. Every card is a shot. Serve, rally and outplay your opponent until someone can't return the ball.

LEARN TO PLAY P. 3–12
Groundstrokes, the serve, the rally, Modifier cards and scoring.

NET CARDS P. 13–14
Volley and Drop-Shot.

TACTICAL CARDS P. 15–16
Smash, Lob and Approach.

SPECIAL CARDS P. 17
Winner, Error and Good Get.

DOUBLES P. 18–19
2 vs 2 with team decks and the Switch!

COACH'S TIPS & QUICK REFERENCE P. 20–23

New players: read Learn to play, then start a match. Look up Net, Tactical and Special cards the first time someone plays one.

LEARN TO PLAY
IN THE BOX



2 decks of 70 cards, one lime and one orange. Each player uses their own deck.



3 dice: the **Serve Die**, the **Volley Die** and the **Drop-Shot Die**.

WHAT'S IN A DECK

GROUNDSTROKES
Forehands and Backhands, the basic shot. Most of your deck.

TACTICAL
Smash, Lob and Approach.

MODIFIERS
Extra Spin and Soft Touch.

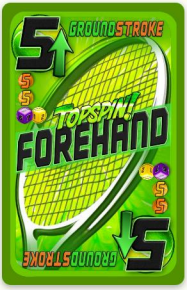
NET CARDS
Volley and Drop-Shot. Roll a die for pace.

SPECIAL
Winner, Error and Good Get.

Learn to play covers groundstrokes and modifiers. Net, Tactical and Special cards each have their own section.

GROUND-STROKES

The basic shot, just like in tennis. Groundstrokes make up most of your deck, and there are two kinds: **Forehands** and **Backhands**.



COLOR = STROKE

GREEN is a **Forehand**.
ORANGE is a **Backhand**.

NUMBER = PACE

How fast the ball is going. **1** is slow, **7** is a rocket.

ARROW = SPIN

↑ **TOPSPIN** speeds the ball up.
↓ **SLICE** slows it down.

SAME PACE, DIFFERENT SHOTS



TOPSPIN FOREHAND 3



FOREHAND SLICE 3



TOPSPIN BACKHAND 3



BACKHAND SLICE 3

SET UP

1. Each player takes a deck and **shuffles** it.
2. Draw a hand of **7 cards**. Keep them hidden from your opponent.
3. Put your deck face down next to you. Keep the **3 dice** where both players can reach them.
4. Flip a coin. The winner **serves first**.

SCORING

Each rally is one **point**. Win it and score 1. **First to 7 points wins the match.**

After each point: discard the cards played, both players draw back up to **7 cards**, and **switch servers**.

THE GOLDEN RULE

Your shot sets the rule for your opponent's return. If they can't return it, you win the point.

Playing 2 vs 2? Learn singles first, then turn to **Doubles** on page 18.

SERVE IT!

Every point starts with a serve. You have two choices:

A **PLAY A GROUNDSTROKE**
Serve any Forehand or Backhand from your hand.

B **ROLL THE SERVE DIE**
Keep your cards and let the die set the pace your opponent must return:



Return at pace **4 or higher**.



Return at pace **5 or higher**.



Return at pace **4 or lower**.



Return at pace **3 or lower**.



LET! See next page.



FAULT! See next page.

A die serve can be returned with a Forehand **or** a Backhand. Only the pace matters.

LET & FAULT



LET

The serve clipped the net. **Both players draw 1 card**, then the server rolls again.



FAULT

The serve missed. Take a **second serve**: roll the Serve Die again.

DOUBLE FAULT

Roll FAULT on your second serve too, and **you lose the point**.

RETURN THE SERVE

The receiver plays a Forehand or Backhand that follows the serve. Now you're in the rally!



SERVE



✓ PACE 6



✓ PACE 5



× TOO SLOW

THE RALLY

Take turns returning each other's groundstrokes. Each return must follow these rules.

1 **MATCH THE COLOR**
Forehand returns Forehand. Backhand returns Backhand.

2 **↑ TOPSPIN SPEEDS IT UP**
Return a Topspin shot with **equal or higher** pace.

3 **↓ SLICE SLOWS IT DOWN**
Return a Slice shot with **equal or lower** pace.

THEY PLAY A TOPSPIN FOREHAND 5



THEIR SHOT



✓ PACE 6



× TOO SLOW



× WRONG COLOR

THEY PLAY A BACKHAND SLICE 3

Return with a Backhand of pace **3, 2 or 1**.



? WILD GROUNDSTROKES
Choose your pace (1 to 7) when you play it. Then it follows all the normal rules.

SWITCH COLORS

Out of the right color? You can still return a groundstroke.

4 MATCH THE PACE EXACTLY

Return a groundstroke with a groundstroke of the **other color** and the **same pace**. The spin doesn't matter.



THEIR SHOT



✓ PACE 4



✓ PACE 4



✕ NOT 4

Switching colors changes the game. Now your opponent has to follow **your** color and **your** spin.

Groundstrokes only. Net, Tactical and Special cards have their own rules (pages 13–17).

THE RALLY RULES

- **1** Match the color.
- **2 ↑** Topspin: equal or higher pace.
- **3 ↓** Slice: equal or lower pace.
- **4 =** Other color? Match the pace exactly (groundstrokes only).

MODIFIER CARDS

Change the pace of your shot. Play a modifier together with the card you're playing.



EXTRA SPIN +1

Adds 1 to the pace of the card you play it with.

They hit a **Topspin Forehand 6**. Your Topspin Forehand 5 + Extra Spin **counts as a 6**. ✓



SOFT TOUCH -1

Takes 1 off the pace of the card you play it with.

They hit a **Backhand Slice 3**. Your Topspin Backhand 4 + Soft Touch **counts as a 3**. ✓

1. **One modifier per shot.** Your card keeps its color and spin.
2. Pace always stays between **1 and 7**.
3. Then **draw 1 card** to replace the modifier.

KEEP IT ALIVE!

LAST DITCH EFFORT

No legal return in your hand? Draw the top card of your deck.

- ✓ **It's a legal return?** Play it. The rally goes on!
- ✓ **It's a modifier** that makes a card in your hand legal? Play them together (page 10).
- ✗ **Anything else?** You lose the point. Keep the card in your hand.

LAST DITCH EFFORT EXAMPLE



THEIR SHOT

NO RETURN? DRAW!



✓ PLAY IT



✗ POINT LOST

DIG DEEP

Used your last card in a rally? Dig Deep: draw cards from your deck and keep playing.

1ST TIME	2ND TIME	AFTER THAT
Draw 3	**Draw 2**	**Draw 1**

Playing it or discarding it with a Good Get both count. If an Approach steals it, try a Last Ditch Effort instead. Counts reset every point.

A POINT, SHOT BY SHOT

ALEX  Serves with the die: **Topspin 5**. Sam must return at pace 5 or higher.

SAM  Plays a **Forehand Slice 6**. Alex needs a Forehand of 6 or lower.

ALEX  Plays a **Topspin Forehand 3**. Sam needs a Forehand of 3 or higher.

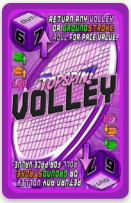
SAM  Nothing in hand works. **Last Ditch Effort!** Sam draws a **Backhand Slice 3**. Same pace, so it's legal. **The rally goes on!**

ALEX  Alex needs a Backhand of 3 or lower, or a Forehand 3. Nothing. **Last Ditch Effort!** Alex draws a **Topspin Backhand 5**. **Too fast.**

Sam wins the point, 1–0. Both refill to 7 cards and Sam serves next.

NET CARDS

VOLLEY



PLAY IT

Return **any groundstroke or Volley**, whatever its pace.

ROLL FOR PACE

Roll the **Volley Die**. The roll is your Volley's pace.

THE VOLLEY DIE



Return at **6 or higher**.



Return at **7**.



NET! You lose the point.



OUT! You lose the point.

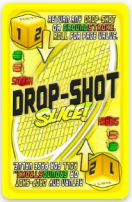
TO RETURN A VOLLEY

Play a **Volley**, a **Lob**, or any groundstroke with pace **equal or higher** than the roll.

COACH'S TIP · WHEN TO VOLLEY

Volley right after they hit a **fast groundstroke (6 or 7)**. They just used a fast shot, so they may not have another one to answer you.

DROP-SHOT



PLAY IT

Return **any groundstroke or Drop-Shot**, whatever its pace.

ROLL FOR PACE

Roll the **Drop-Shot Die**. The roll is your Drop-Shot's pace.

THE DROP-SHOT DIE



Return at **1**.



Return at **2 or lower**.



NET! You lose the point.



OUT! You lose the point.

TO RETURN A DROP-SHOT

Play a **Drop-Shot**, a **Smash**, or any groundstroke with pace **equal or lower** than the roll.

COACH'S TIP · WHEN TO DROP IT

Drop-Shot right after they hit a **slow groundstroke (1 or 2)**. They just used a slow shot, so they may not have another one to reach it.

TACTICAL CARDS

SMASH & LOB

Tactical cards only return a **specific pace**. Their number is their own pace.



SMASH PUNISH A SLOW BALL

Play it on a **pace 1 or 2** shot, including a **Lob** or a **Drop-Shot**.

To return it: a groundstroke of pace **equal or higher** than the Smash (6 or 7), or a **Lob**.



LOB BEAT A FAST BALL

Play it on a **pace 6 or 7** shot, including a **Smash** or a **Volley**.

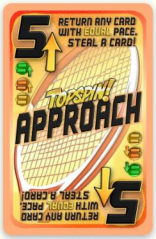
To return it: a groundstroke of pace **equal or lower** than the Lob (1 or 2), or a **Smash**.

COACH'S TIP · SET IT UP WITH A NET CARD

Volley, then Lob. If they answer your Volley with a Volley or a fast groundstroke, the ball is coming back at 6 or 7. Lob it! **Drop-Shot, then Smash** works the same way at the slow end. (See page 21.)

APPROACH

Match their pace, then steal a card.



TOPSPIN APPROACH 5



APPROACH SLICE 3

PLAY IT

Play the **Topspin Approach 5** on any pace 5 shot, or the **Approach Slice 3** on any pace 3 shot. Then **steal 1 random card** from your opponent's hand.

To return it: ↑5 pace 5 or higher. ↓3 pace 3 or lower.

COACH'S TIP · STRETCH YOUR APPROACH

Add a **modifier** to reach other paces. Approach 5 + Soft Touch counts as a **4**. Approach 3 + Extra Spin counts as a **4** too. Now it can answer a pace 4 shot, and you still steal a card.



SPECIAL CARDS



WINNER!

Play it on a shot of pace **3, 4 or 5**. **You win the point.** No return.



ERROR!

Play it on a shot of pace **1, 2, 6 or 7**, or as your **serve**. **You lose the point.** Nobody's perfect, even the pros!



GOOD GET!

Return **any** shot, at any pace. Then discard 1 card.

To return it: play **any card**.

Discarded your last card? **Dig Deep** (page 11).

COACH'S TIPS

Save your Winner for a big moment. **Stuck with an Error?** Serve it, discard it with a Good Get, or hope an Approach steals it!

2 VS 2
DOUBLES

SET UP

1. Make 2 teams of 2. Each team shares **one 70-card deck**.
2. Each player draws **5 cards**. Want longer rallies? Draw **7**.

TAKE TURNS

Players return shots in this order, around and around:

TEAM A · P1 → **TEAM B · P1** → **TEAM A · P2** → **TEAM B · P2**

The server rotates in the same order, one new server each point.

TALK IT OVER

Partners can talk **before the point**. Once the serve is played, **no talking** until the point is over.

SAME RULES, SAME SCORE

Every singles rule still applies. After each point, everyone refills to 5 (or 7). **First team to 7 points wins.**

SWITCH!

Stuck on your turn? Call **"Switch!"** Each team gets one Switch per point, but **not on the return of serve**.

1. Your partner looks at the shot on the table and picks **1 card** they think can return it.
2. They pass it to you **face down**. You pass **1 card** back face down.
3. Pick up your new card and **take your turn**. A Switch doesn't use up your turn.

STILL STUCK?

Try a **Last Ditch Effort**, just like singles. Your team can't Switch again for the rest of the point.

PARTNER TIP

No talking during the point, so watch the shot on the table. If your partner calls Switch, you already know what they need.

COACH'S TIPS



GROUNDSTROKES

1. **Switch colors to throw them off.** If the rally has been all Forehands, a same-pace Backhand suddenly makes them find a Backhand.
2. **Change the spin.** Topspin pushes them up the pace, Slice drags them down. Flip it when you think their hand is full of high cards, or low ones.
3. **Slow down a big hitter.** A low-pace Slice forces them to stay low too.

MODIFIERS

4. **Keep a modifier for when you're one pace short.** It turns a near miss into a return, and you draw a card too.

NET CARDS

5. **Pick your moment.** Volley right after they hit a fast groundstroke (6 or 7). Drop-Shot right after a slow one (1 or 2). They just spent that shot, so they may not have another.
6. **Net cards are a gamble.** NET or OUT loses the point, so they shine when you'd lose it anyway.

COMBO PLAYS

Net cards and Tactical cards work great together. Set up the shot, then finish it.

VOLLEY, THEN LOB



YOU: VOLLEY → THEY: VOLLEY OR 6–7 → YOU: LOB!

A Volley forces a fast reply. Fast balls are exactly what a Lob is for.

DROP-SHOT, THEN SMASH



YOU: DROP-SHOT → THEY: DROP-SHOT OR 1–2 → YOU: SMASH!

A Drop-Shot forces a slow reply. Slow balls are begging to be Smashed.

Approach + modifier: a Soft Touch or Extra Spin lets your Approach answer a pace 4 shot (or 2, or 6) and still steal a card. See page 16.

MORE TIPS



SPECIAL CARDS

1. **Save your Winner.** It only works on pace 3, 4 or 5, so hold it for a big point.
2. **Serve your Error.** Play it as your serve so you don't burn good cards in a rally first. Or play it when you can afford to lose a point, like when you're well ahead.
3. **Good Get cleans up.** It returns anything, then lets you discard a card. Make that card your Error!
4. **Count your cards.** If your hand runs out mid-rally, Dig Deep keeps you alive, but each one gives you fewer cards.

DOUBLES

5. **Plan during the talk time.** Once the serve is played, you're on your own.
6. **Watch the table.** If your partner calls Switch, look at the shot they need to return and pass them a card that can do it.

Now get out there and serve it up!

QUICK REFERENCE



1 **Match the color.** Forehand returns Forehand, Backhand returns Backhand.

2↑ **Topspin:** same color, **equal or higher** pace.

3↓ **Slice:** same color, **equal or lower** pace.

4 = **Other color:** match the pace, regardless of spin (groundstrokes only).

±1 **Modifier:** one per shot, then draw 1.

VOLLEY Any groundstroke or Volley. Roll. Return equal or higher, a Volley or a Lob.

DROP-SHOT Any groundstroke or Drop-Shot. Roll. Return equal or lower, a Drop-Shot or a Smash.

SMASH on 1–2. **LOB** on 6–7. They always return each other.

APPROACH on equal pace (5 or 3), then steal 1 card.

WINNER on 3–5 wins. **ERROR** on 1, 2, 6, 7 or as a serve loses.

GOOD GET returns anything, then discard 1.

STUCK? Last Ditch Effort: draw 1 and try it.

LAST CARD? Dig Deep: draw 3, then 2, then 1.

SCORE One point per rally. **First to 7 wins.**



TENNIS WITH A TWIST!

2–4 PLAYERS · SINGLES & DOUBLES · AGES 8+

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